*Assess strategies that operations management may use to respond to influences of technology, quality expectations and Corporate Social Responsibility*.

This task was well done by many students with good use of case study/ies showing an effort had been made to prepare and remember data about a range of businesses. Students were able to, at the very least, make reference to case study/ies and many were able to use mostly relevant case studies.

Better responses showed a clear understanding of the syllabus with clear explanation of the appropriate terms that were appropriate in answering the question (eg quality control, quality assurance and continuous improvement) and then used their case study to support their response. While most students showed some understanding of appropriate case studies better response were able to relate these to specific changes in the operational process and were able to provide statistics (metrics) to show how responses to the influences affected operations management, rather than just providing information on profit and revenue.

Lesser response may have provided statistics showing improvements that were not necessarily related to operations management strategies, this was especially an issue in dealing with Corporate Social Responsibility where marketing issues were often present. They also became involved in a general discussion of the case study without specific reference to the question. Time must be allotted to show a precise understanding of the syllabus prior to moving into the case study analysis.

Some responses showed a lack of planning as indicated by not completing the last part of their response and in the lack of a logical progression in dealing with the question. The readability of answers was an issue with some. The minimal use of paragraphs and lack of setting out making some answers difficult to read. A simple rule of one idea per paragraph is worth considering.

Moving forward, it is important to use this feedback, read the exemplar carefully and consider very carefully the examples you use to demonstrate linkages. Also, answer the question asked.